

SWITZERLAND

Switzerland – Key Country Details Table

Detail	Information
Full Name	Swiss Confederation
Short Form	Switzerland
Capital	Bern
Region (UN)	Western European and Others Group (WEOG)
Government Type	Federal semi-direct democracy under a multi-party system
Head of State	Viola Amherd (President of the Swiss Confederation, 2025)
Head of Government	Federal Council (collective executive; led by the President rotating annually)
Currency	Swiss Franc (CHF)
UN Member Since	10 September 2002
MUN Standing	Neutral, highly respected; active in diplomacy, peacebuilding, and humanitarian efforts

Recommended Books on Switzerland’s Foreign Policy & UN Engagement

1. "Swiss Foreign Policy: Foundations and Future"
2. "Neutrality and the European Union: The Case of Switzerland"
3. "Switzerland and the United Nations: A Close Relationship"
4. "The Swiss Confederation: A Brief Guide"
5. "Switzerland's Role in International Organizations"

Research Table: Switzerland & the UNHRC

Source Name	Link	Why It’s Useful
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Swiss Federal Department of Foreign Affairs (FDFA)	<u>Human Rights in Switzerland</u>	Official Swiss government portal detailing Switzerland's human rights policies and international commitments, foundational for official stance and diplomacy.
Office of the United Nations High Commissioner for Human Rights (OHCHR) – Switzerland	<u>Switzerland Country Profile</u>	UN OHCHR country page with treaty status, reports, and recommendations. Essential for understanding Switzerland's UN-level human rights engagement.
Amnesty International Switzerland	<u>Amnesty International CH</u>	Local branch of Amnesty International focusing on Swiss human rights issues and campaigns. Useful for NGO critical insights.
Human Rights Watch – Switzerland	<u>HRW Switzerland</u>	NGO reports on human rights concerns and trends in Switzerland. Good for independent analysis.
International Justice Resource Center (IJRC) – Switzerland	<u>IJRC Switzerland</u>	Provides legal resources and analysis of Swiss human rights laws in international context. Useful for legal research.
Swiss Peace Foundation (swisspeace)	<u>Swisspeace Human Rights Research</u>	Research institute focusing on conflict and human rights, helpful for understanding Switzerland's peace and human rights diplomacy.
Swiss Federal Department of Justice and Police (FDJP)	<u>Justice and Human Rights</u>	Government portal detailing justice and policing policies, relevant for rights protections and challenges.
UNHRC Statements by Switzerland	<u>Switzerland Statements</u>	Official Swiss statements and positions at UNHRC sessions, useful for diplomatic stance and advocacy.
Council of Europe – Switzerland	<u>Council of Europe Switzerland</u>	Regional human rights context involving Switzerland, important for EU/CoE and UN alignment.
Global Detention Project – Switzerland	<u>Detention and Refugees</u>	Reports on detention conditions in Switzerland, especially for migrants and refugees, relevant to UNHRC migration discussions.

Unique Aspects of Switzerland in the UNHRC Context

1. **Host of the UN Human Rights Council Headquarters:** Geneva, Switzerland, is home to the main seat of the UN Human Rights Council, which positions Switzerland as a key player in the realm of global human rights diplomacy. By hosting and facilitating important UN processes, the country plays a vital role in shaping discussions and actions around human rights issues.
2. **Long-standing Tradition of Neutrality:** Switzerland's commitment to political neutrality allows it to serve as an unbiased mediator in human rights disputes, boosting its credibility and soft power at the UNHRC.
3. **Strong National Human Rights Institution:** The Swiss Federal Commission for Human Rights works independently to keep an eye on human rights issues. They provide strong reporting and accountability measures that are acknowledged on an international level.
4. **Comprehensive Refugee and Asylum Policies:** Switzerland has a comprehensive legal framework regarding asylum and refugee protection, which plays a significant role in shaping discussions at the UNHRC about migration rights and humanitarian protections.
5. **Pioneer in Business and Human Rights:** Switzerland stands out as a global frontrunner in crafting national action plans that address the human rights impacts of corporations, establishing international standards in UN discussions.
6. **Hub for International Human Rights Law and NGOs:** The abundance of international organizations and NGOs in Switzerland fosters a vibrant atmosphere for advocating rights and conducting research, which in turn boosts engagement with the UNHRC.
7. **Multi-Lingual and Multi-Cultural Rights Framework:** Switzerland's unique federal structure, with its rich tapestry of official languages and diverse cultures, calls for a thoughtful approach to rights. This complexity is often highlighted in discussions at the UN Human Rights Council.
8. **Focus on Peace and Conflict Resolution:** Swiss organizations such as swisspeace play a crucial role in weaving human rights into the fabric of

peacebuilding. Their efforts significantly shape discussions at the UN Human Rights Council regarding protections for rights affected by conflict.

9. **High-Quality Legal Aid and Justice System:** Switzerland boasts a robust legal framework that guarantees access to justice and upholds fair trial rights, aligning perfectly with the standards and recommendations set by the UNHRC.
 10. **Active in Promoting International Human Rights Treaties:** Switzerland is known for consistently ratifying and putting into action international human rights treaties. They often advocate for more robust monitoring mechanisms for these treaties within the UN Human Rights Council.
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